

THE AVERAGERS



SUBIR HALDER



AMBIKA SONI

• I&B Minister

● **AGENDA** The long-pending Broadcast Bill has to be cleared and consensus has to be mobilised on the content code. Soni has herself prioritised projecting India during the Commonwealth Games.

● **PERFORMANCE** With the media, the less you do, the better it is. And Soni seems to have realised this by not getting nudged into any reactionary moves when MPs demanded an end to "vulgarity on television". Instead she pointed out how the Broadcast Bill was due, reinstated meetings with stakeholders, spoke up for media freedom, and came up to speed up the complicated legislation she had inherited. Tied herself up in knots on the Shah Rukh immigration issue though.



KUMARI SELJA

• Tourism and Poverty Alleviation Minister

● **AGENDA** A Sonia Gandhi favourite, Selja has been given charge of one of the UPA's flagship schemes—the Rajiv Gandhi Awas Yojana—for affordable housing. She also has to provide a safe India to tourists for the Commonwealth Games.

● PERFORMANCE

No out-of-the-box initiative has come from her as yet. Her promise of formulating the Rajiv Gandhi Awas Yojana for approval within the first 100 days has now been shifted to the year-end. She has urged the states to deploy tourist police at hotspots for protecting women tourists.



SIPRA DAS



SHARAD PAWAR

• Agriculture Minister

● **AGENDA** A National Food Security Act to provide food for all was one of the flagship schemes. Setting up the National Mission on Sustainable Agriculture was also on the cards. Pawar has to control food prices and rein in drought impact which has affected rice production.

● PERFORMANCE

Drought relief seems high on his list as he has not been able to control food prices. He has asked states to purchase half of the total rice procured by private millers so they can intervene in the open market. The Food Security Bill is caught in wrangling at the state level. His seed evangelism is a significant initiative.



SIPRA DAS